AYA ABOULHOSN

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Updated: August 2026
Citizenship: United States & Lebanon

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Washington College, Maryland, USA *August 2026 –*
Visiting Assistant Professor of Economics

EDUCATION

American University *May 2026*
Ph.D. in Economics
Committee: Nathan Larson (chair), Austin Davis, Maria Caballero Sanchez

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona *2017*
M.S. in Economics, Minor in Public Policy

University of California, Los Angeles *2016*
B.A. in Economics, Minor in Arabic

PUBLICATIONS

"Refugee Immigration and Natives' Fertility," ***Journal of Development Economics,*** (2027) vol. 184, 103901, with Cevat Giray Aksoy and Berkay Özcan
"Impact of Political Risk on Emerging Market Risk Premiums and Risk Adjusted Returns," ***Research in International Business and Finance***, (2025) vol. 73(A), 102573, with Ralph Sonenshine

WORKING PAPERS

"Refugees and Access to Maternal Health Care Resources: Evidence from Turkey" (job market paper)
"The Impact of Remittances on Household Consumption: Evidence from Jordan"

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Do Migrants and Natives Differ in Health Care Usage? Evidence from Venezuelan Refugees in Colombia" with Sebastian Bauhoff and Sofia Castro Vargas
"Declining Terms of Trade after Experiencing Trade Marginalization: Global Evidence from 1982 to 2020" with Bernhard Gunter and Eduardo Lederman Rawet

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

World Bank Washington, D.C.
Consultant, Development Economics Vice Presidency *2022–2023; 2025–2026*

- Design research and analyze datasets on impact of artificial intelligence on health, education and labor markets for World Development Report 2026
- Executed data collection and econometric analysis on health budget allocations, increased database from 25 to 110 countries in first of its kind dataset
- Managed data collection activities on health and labor market measures to create experimental datasets for causal analysis, publish reports, and present evidence-based recommendations to stakeholders

World Bank Beirut, Lebanon
Consultant, Poverty & Equity *2020–2022*

- Managed quantitative data collection and econometric analysis of economic vulnerability, health, gender and employment outcomes of Lebanese nationals and Syrian refugees

- Led a team of 30 enumerators, designed survey instruments, sampling framework, and quality control of data

Inter-American Development Bank Washington, D.C.
Summer Graduate, Health Economics *Jun. 2024–Aug. 2024*

- Lead research and analysis on administrative hospital data of Colombian natives and Venezuelan migrants to assess disparities in healthcare access

Siren Associates Beirut, Lebanon
Data Management Officer *2020*

- Designed and executed quantitative data collection in the security sector, trained 20+ enumerators on survey instruments to collect data from nationals and refugees
- Provided rigorous statistical analysis of data and recommendations based on results

Centre for Lebanese Studies Beirut, Lebanon
Junior Researcher *Jul.–Dec. 2019*

- Conducted quantitative analysis of refugee education programs in 40+ public schools across Lebanon
- Modified survey instruments and engaged stakeholders (ministries, schools, NGOs) for research execution

Wageningen University (Development Economics Group) Freetown, Sierra Leone
Research Associate *Feb.–Jun. 2019*

- Led impact evaluation to assess the causal impact of a rural electrification project across 100+ sites in Sierra Leone on labor, health, education and environmental outcome

Guinness Atkinson Asset Management Los Angeles, CA
Analyst *Feb. 2018–Feb. 2019*

- Researched macroeconomic policies affecting mutual fund portfolios in emerging markets and energy sectors, delivered presentations to clients and supported engagements in New York, London, and Miami offices

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Visiting Assistant Professor, Washington College *Fall 2026-present*
Econ 211: Intermediate Macroeconomics *Fall 2026*
Econ 111: Principles of Macroeconomics *Fall 2026*
Adjunct Professor, Catholic University of America *Fall 2023-present*
Econ 241: Intermediate Macroeconomics *Fall 2023 & 2024*
Teaching Assistant, American University *Fall 2021-2024*

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

J-PAL's MENA Scholars Fellowship *Sept. 2024-present*
Merit Graduate Assistantship & Fellowship, American University *2020 – 2024*

PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

Presenter (2023-2026): AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia; Conference on Political Economy & Development, Georgetown University; Salisbury University Seminar; Towson International Development Economics Symposium; PAA Annual Meeting, Washington D.C.; EEA Annual Meeting, New York; AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, San Francisco; CEMIR Junior Economist Workshop on Migration Research, Munich, Germany; Washington Area Development Economics Symposium; Southern Economic Association, New Orleans

SKILLS

Computer: STATA, R, SPSS, Mathematica, ODK Collect, Kobo Toolbox, Microsoft Office, LaTeX
Languages: English (fluent), Arabic (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)